

time pinching pennies when I could be taking on more work from home and coming out ahead.

However, as a stay-at-home mom of two kids below school age, one thing is certain: I can't make any more money than I already do without spending money on a babysitter. Clipping coupons, making extra grocery trips (on foot with the stroller) to buy loss leaders, reading the sales flyers—these are all things I can manage with the children with me. At first flipping through a coupon file while controlling the kids in the store was difficult, but now I have the hang of it and it's working out. Actually, my four-year-old has kind of gotten into helping me, and this is how she now asks for something:

"Mommy, if such-and-such is on sale, and you have a coupon, can we get it?"

That's my girl. — **Carrie Kirby**



8 Tips for the High-End Cheapskate

Here at Wise Bread, we're not just about saving money and reducing budgets. We're also about provid-

ing ways to live a more luxurious lifestyle within a reduced set of financial parameters. In other words, we show you how to be a high-end cheapskate. Here are eight tips to do just that.

1. Decanters

Don't feel like justifying your brand choices to new acquaintances? Prefer the look of fine crystal or cut glass to bottle labels? Decanters are a great way to add class to your bar or entertaining area and make sure the brands of spirits you choose are nobody's business but yours.

2. Heirloom and estate jewelry

Whether it's handed down, purchased at auction, or picked up at pawn shops, previously owned jewelry is a great way to establish a nice collection for a significantly reduced price. Think pearls and studs for women, pocket watches and tie clips for men.

3. Maximize gourmet purchases

There are two ways to get the biggest bang for your gourmet buck. First, stretch fancy items as far as possible as an accent ingredient. This can be done with truffles, shaved specialty cheeses for pasta dinners, sliced steak